Mikey Jarrell

Department of Economics, University of California San Diego
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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of California, San Diego — Expected 2029
Fields: Development Economics, Environmental Economics

Advisor: Paul Niehaus

M.A.Sc. in Economics, Massachusetts Institute of Technology — 2022
Data, Economics, and Development Policy (DEDP)

U. of Rochester / SUNY Empire State / Monroe CC — 2021
Post-baccalaureate work in mathematics

B.A., Bowdoin College — 2014
Majors: Romance Languages, Neuroscience

Research

Publications

Duflo, E., Hsiao, A., Jarrell, M., and Lazarus, N. (2026). "Schooling and Labor Market Consequences of School Construction in Indonesia: A Reply to Roodman." *Journal of Comments and Replications in Economics*, 5(2026-6). doi:10.18718/81781.57

In Progress

Who's in Charge? Reducing Pollution from Lead Battery Repair
Lead Pollution and Exposure from Battery Recycling Firms in Nigeria
Brazilian Battery Boom: Tax Breaks as Anti-Pollution Policy
Beijing Battery Bust: Was China's Crackdown on Lead Battery Firms Worth It?

Ideas

O-Ring Theory of Enforcement: The Corruption–Complexity Tradeoff
Fair Trade for Lead: Environmental Quality Certifications and International Trade
Lead Poisoning in Poor Countries: Causes, Effects, and Solutions

Teaching

University of California, San Diego

ECON 100B: Microeconomics B (TA for J. Boomhower)	Spring 2026
ECON 145: Economics of Ocean Resources (TA for D. Squires)	Winter 2026
GPS 457: Cost–Benefit Analysis (TA for D. Squires)	Fall 2025
ECON 144: Economics of Conservation (TA for D. Squires)	Summer 2025
ECON 132: Energy Economics (TA for R. Carson)	Spring 2025
ECON 100B: Microeconomics B (TA for S. Levkoff)	Winter 2025
GPS 457: Cost–Benefit Analysis (TA for D. Squires)	Fall 2024

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

14.73x: Challenges of Global Poverty, MITx Online (for E. Duflo) 2023
Course developer: designed all labs; wrote all exercises and final exam questions

14.75(0): Political Econ. and Econ. Dev. (TA for E. Duflo and S. Lowes)	Spring 2023
DEDP Master's Math Camp (Instructor)	Winter 2023
14.73: Challenges of Global Poverty (TA for E. Duflo and F. Schilbach)	Fall 2022
14.009: Economics and Society's Toughest Problems (TA for E. Duflo)	Fall 2022

Other

USTalk (online): English as a Second Language (Instructor)	2016
Building Dignity Community Center (Lima, Peru): Math and English (Tutor)	2013

Fellowships and Grants

Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics ($14,140)	2025
Center for Global Development ($122,580)	2025
Center for Global Development ($61,778)	2025
21st Century India Center ($4,000)	2025
J-PAL King Climate Action Initiative ($4,334)	2024
Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics ($3,896)	2024
Fulcrum Project Fellowship ($20,000)	2023

Invited Talks

Center for Global Development 2026
Mapping the Opportunity: A Global Standard for ULAB Supply Chain Transparency

Center for Global Development 2025
Brazilian Battery Boom: Tax Breaks as Anti-Pollution Policy

Upgrading the Lead-acid Battery Recycling Sector in the African Region 2025
Push and Pull: The Power of Incentives and Enforcement to Fight Pollution

Relevant Experience

Research Assistant to Paul Niehaus, UC San Diego 2026–
Lead exposure and cardiovascular disease

Applied Research Lead, Partnership for Battery Action 2025–
Research Assistant to Esther Duflo, J-PAL/MIT 2022–23

Personal

Citizenship: United States
Languages: English (native), Spanish (fluent), French (advanced), Italian (advanced), Portuguese (intermediate)
Interests: Racquet sports, basketball, disc golf, baseball, lead poisoning

Not-So-Relevant Experience

Professional Golfer, World Long Drive 2018–20
Project Manager, 2020 MicroClinic Initiative (Nairobi, Kenya) 2017–19
Photographer and Documentary Filmmaker, Average Content (Rochester, NY) 2014–19
Safari Guide, Field Guides Association of Southern Africa (NQF2) 2018
Scuba Dive Assistant, Octopus Diving (Saint Martin; PADI Rescue) 2017
Sportswriter, The Sports Quotient 2016–17
Camp Counselor, Night Eagle Wilderness Adventures (Wallingford, VT) 2015
Research Assistant, Forensic Economics Inc. (Rochester, NY) 2014–15